Transforming Customer Experiences: A UX Design Case Study for Foodie Explorer

Jessica A. Miller

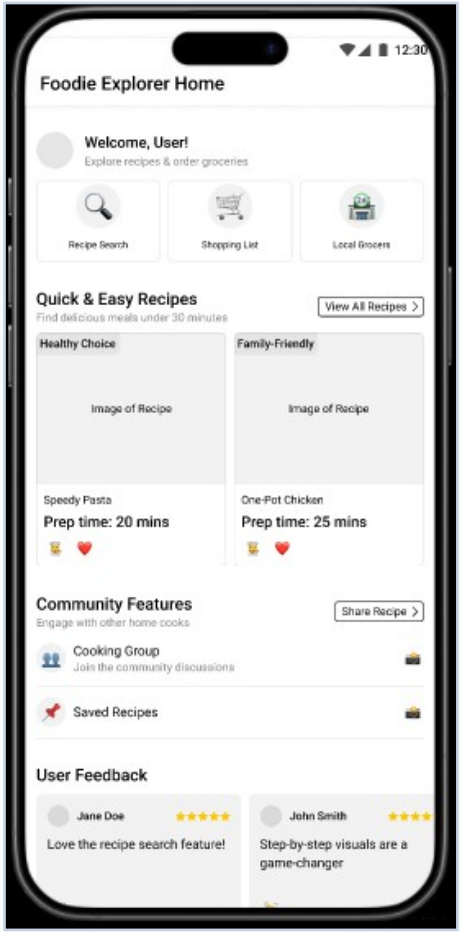
Project overview

The product:

A mobile app called “Foodie Explorer”

Project duration:

3-6 months



Project overview

The problem:
David is a freelance photographer who needs a reliable and efficient way to look up recipes and order groceries online.

The goal:
Our Foodie Explorer app lets users search for recipes and order groceries for delivery. It is designed for busy professionals who want to cook healthy meals, support local businesses, and avoid the cost of pre-packaged meal subscriptions. We will measure how well it works with in-app surveys.

Project overview

My role:

Lead UX Designer and Researcher

Responsibilities:

- Conducted user research (surveys, usability studies).
- Synthesized research to identify pain points and user needs.
- Redesigned the app with better search, personalized suggestions, and simpler navigation.
- Developed wireframes and a low-fidelity prototype.
- Added accessibility improvements and changes users asked for (e.g., streamlined checkout, intuitive search).

01

Understanding the user

- User research
- Personas
- Problem statements
- User journey maps

User research: summary



For the Foodie Explorer UX case study, I used surveys and usability tests to learn what busy professionals need from a better way to find recipes and buy groceries.

At first, I thought users cared most about convenience, but the research showed they also wanted meal planning, step-by-step visual instructions, and ways to support local businesses.

These findings led to a redesign focused on easy search, personalized suggestions, and simpler navigation to improve the user experience.

User research: pain points

1

Time Constraints

Users struggle to find time for grocery shopping and meal planning.

2

Inconsistent Quality

Users were frustrated by inconsistent freshness and availability from previous grocery delivery services.

3

Complex Navigation

Some grocery and recipe apps were hard to navigate and felt overwhelming.

4

Lack of Personalization

Many apps do not tailor recipe recommendations to dietary needs and ingredients on hand, so users waste time searching for recipes that fit.

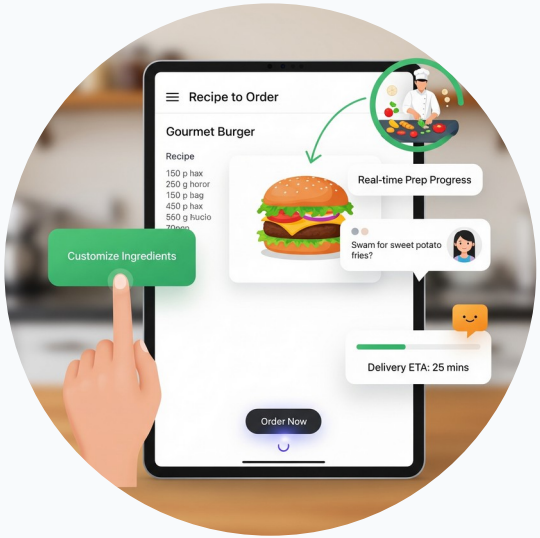
Key Learnings and Impact

01 User-centered design is crucial for effective solutions.

02 Streamlining the recipe-to-order process saves significant time.

03 Small usability changes greatly enhance the user experience.

04 Iterative design based on real user feedback is essential.



Persona: **David Miller**

Problem statement:

David Miller is a 42-year-old busy professional who needs a reliable and efficient way to look up recipes and order groceries online.

Persona based on user research for this case study.



Name: David Miller

Age: 42

Hometown: Portland, Oregon

Education: Bachelor of Fine Arts in Photography from the University of Oregon

Family: Married to Sarah, two children (ages 8 and 10)

Occupation: Freelance photographer (portraits and events)

David rushes home from a wedding shoot, exhausted, dreaming of a quick meal instead of the grocery store. Family dinner night is coming, and he dreads it. A romantic date night is planned, but he has no time or inspiration to cook. He needs a solution that saves time, lets him explore new cuisines, and simplifies his busy life.

"Life's too short for boring meals and grocery store lines. I need a solution that's as creative as my photography."

Goals:

- **Save Time:** Reclaim hours spent on grocery shopping and errands.
- **Enjoy Family Time:** Spend more quality time with his wife and children.
- **Explore New Foods:** Discover new cuisines and dishes.
- **Support Local Businesses:** Find and support local restaurants and food producers.
- **Simplify Life:** Streamline his weekly routine and reduce stress.

Frustrations:

- **Time Constraints:** Juggling photography shoots, family commitments, and household chores leaves little time for grocery shopping.
- **Grocery Store Hassle:** Dislikes the crowds, long lines, and how long in-store shopping takes.
- **Limited Time for Cooking:** Busy schedule leaves little time to cook elaborate meals.
- **Finding Quality Ingredients:** Hard to find fresh, local, high-quality produce and other groceries.
- **Inconsistent Quality:** Frustrated with inconsistent quality from previous grocery delivery services.

User journey map

David's journey shows he wants a seamless grocery shopping experience. He wants a solution that saves time, makes ordering easy, and gives him high-quality products. An app built for his needs can build brand loyalty, drive word-of-mouth referrals, and show what customers prefer.

Action	Learn about the service and its benefits	Gather information and compare options	Make a purchase	Receive the order and check quality	Share experiences and build trust with the company
Task List	See an ad, hear from a friend Browse the website	Research features Compare prices Read reviews	Place order Select payment Confirm order	Track delivery Receive order Unpack order	Rate the experience Share on social media Reorder
Feeling Adjective	Curious Intrigued	Hesitant Uncertain	Excited Anxious	Impatient Excited Delighted	Satisfied Generous Loyal
Improvement Opportunities	More targeted ads, referral program, eye-catching visuals	Easier navigation, high-quality photos, clear filtering options	Faster checkout, multiple payment options, order confirmation email	Estimated delivery window, order tracking updates, easy-to-reach customer support	Incentivize reviews, shareable social media posts, loyalty program

Foodie Explorer: Features & Benefits

- Smart Recipe Discovery: Search for recipes from ingredients you already have, your dietary needs, preferred cuisine, or cooking time. No more wasted food or endless scrolling, just instant options that fit your lifestyle.
- Quick & Easy Recipes: Weeknight meals ready in 30 minutes or less. For busy people who still want delicious, home-cooked food.
- Step-by-Step Visual Guides: Clear instructions and visuals make cooking approachable for everyone, even beginners. No guesswork, just great results.
- Integrated Grocery Lists: The app builds shopping lists from your chosen recipes, so grocery trips are simpler and faster.
- Meal Planning Tools: Plan meals for the week to avoid last-minute stress and eat well.
- Features: Save your favorite recipes, share your cooking, and find inspiration from other home cooks.

Foodie Explorer: Features & Benefits

Foodie Explorer simplifies every step of meal prep, from finding recipes to planning, shopping, and cooking. It's not just an app, it's a stress-reliever, a time-saver, and a way to bring joy back to home cooking. With Foodie Explorer, you'll save time, reduce waste, and eat better without the hassle.

Why It Matters to Our Users:

- *For busy schedules:* The quick recipes and grocery tools make life easier for professionals with little free time.
- *For inspiration:* Smart discovery and community sharing spark creativity and keep meals exciting.
- *For cooking confidence:* Visual instructions help even novice cooks succeed in the kitchen.
- *For healthier habits:* Meal planning and ingredient control lead to better eating for you and your family.

Connection: We designed Foodie Explorer for people who want great meals but don't have hours to spare. By combining smart discovery, intuitive tools, and a supportive community, we meet you at every stage, helping you reclaim time, reduce stress, and enjoy home-cooked meals.

02

Starting the design

- Paper wireframes
- Digital wireframes
- Low-fidelity prototype
- Usability studies

Paper wireframes

Foodie Explorer app wireframe. A clean, user-friendly layout with:

- Recipe Discovery section
- Quick & Easy Recipes for busy users
- Step-by-Step Visual Guides
- Integrated Grocery Lists
- Meal Planning Tools
- Community Features

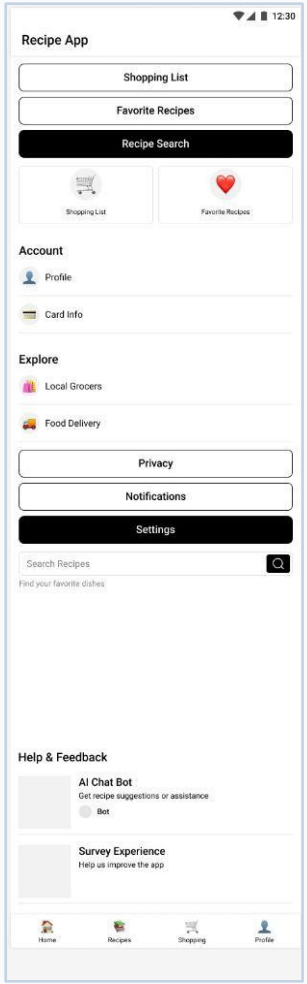


Digital wireframes

Wireframe Example:

1. Layout:
   - Search bar at the top with placeholder text: *"Search recipes by ingredients, dietary needs, cuisine, or time."*
   - Below the search bar, a horizontal row of filter chips (e.g., *Vegetarian*, *Under 30 mins*, *Asian Cuisine*).
   - Recipe cards show:
     - A thumbnail of the dish.
     - Title, cooking time, and key tags (e.g., *Gluten-Free, Quick*).
2. Call-to-Actions (CTAs):
   - Search button beside the search bar.
   - Save recipe: a small heart icon on recipe cards.
3. Usability Enhancements:
   - Sticky bottom navigation bar for quick access to other sections (e.g., *Home*, *Meal Planner*, *Community*).
   - Clean, minimalist design with plenty of white space.

Recipe Search



Easy Navigation

Low-fidelity prototype

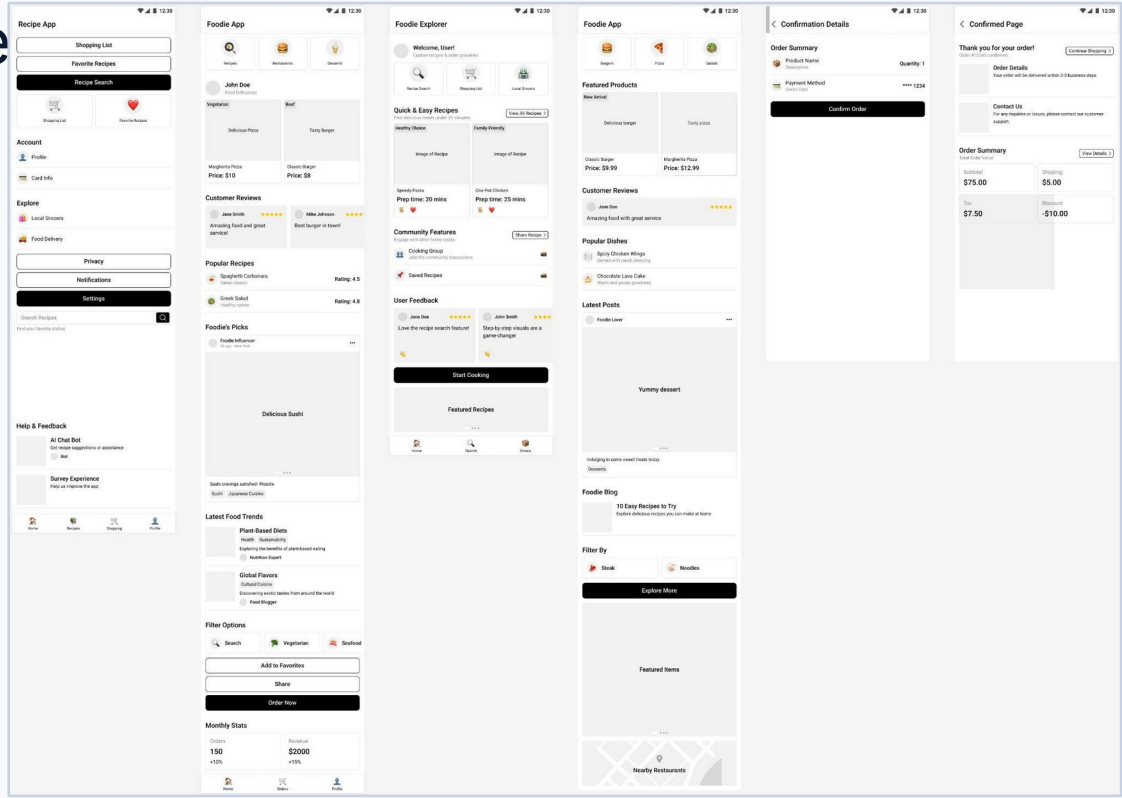
Goals & Thought Process:

Addresses"Time Constraints" by simplifying the path from recipe selection to grocery ordering. The goal was to end manual list-making and simplify checkout.

Element & User Benefit:

Element: Auto-generated grocery list and a streamlined, one-page checkout.

Benefit: One tap adds all recipe ingredients to a shopping list, and checkout is quick, saving busy professionals significant time.



Usability study: findings

We ran a usability study on Foodie Explorer's core features: recipe search and grocery ordering. Users valued an intuitive search bar and filters, and step-by-step visual guides for recipes. These findings drove key design improvements.

Round 1 findings

1. **Intuitive Search: The search bar and filters were easy to use and made recipe discovery simple.**
2. **Visual Guides: Step-by-step visuals built confidence, especially for novice cooks.**
3. **Streamlined Navigation: The minimalist design made navigation quick and straightforward.**

Round 2 findings

1. Larger text and high-contrast mode improved usability for more users.
2. Personalized recommendations made the app feel tailored to each user.
3. A streamlined checkout cut the time to complete grocery orders and improved satisfaction.

03

Refining the design

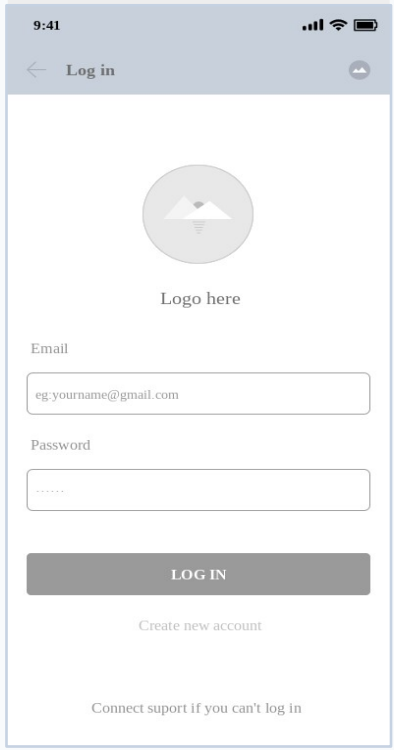
- Mockups
- High-fidelity prototype
- Accessibility

Mockups

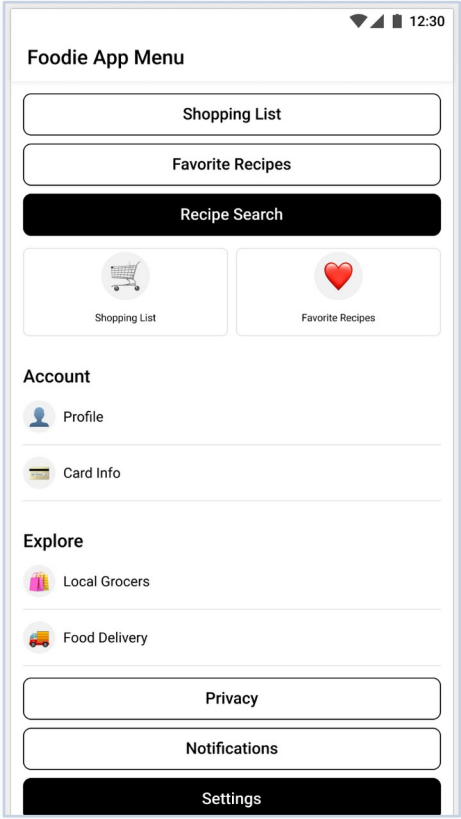
Before Usability Study: Simple layout and basic navigation, but no personalization or accessibility features.

After Usability Study: Better search filters, larger buttons, and personalized recommendations made navigation smoother and more intuitive.

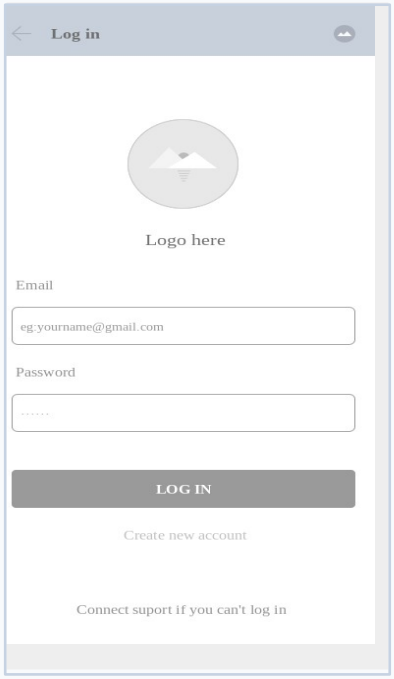
Before usability study



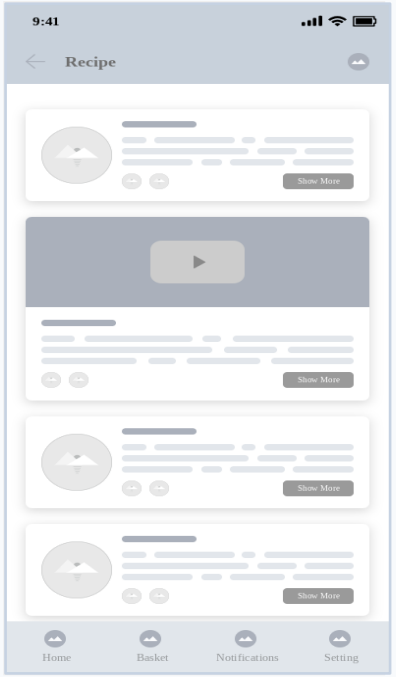
After usability study



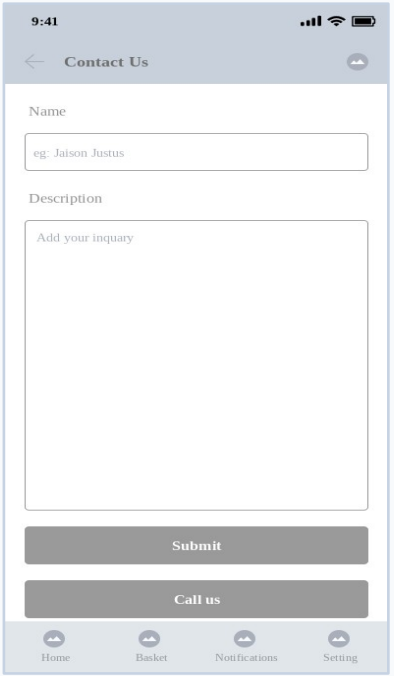
Mockups



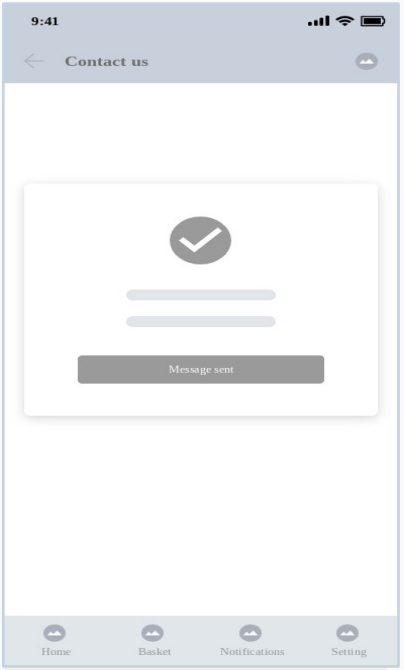
Log in



Recipe

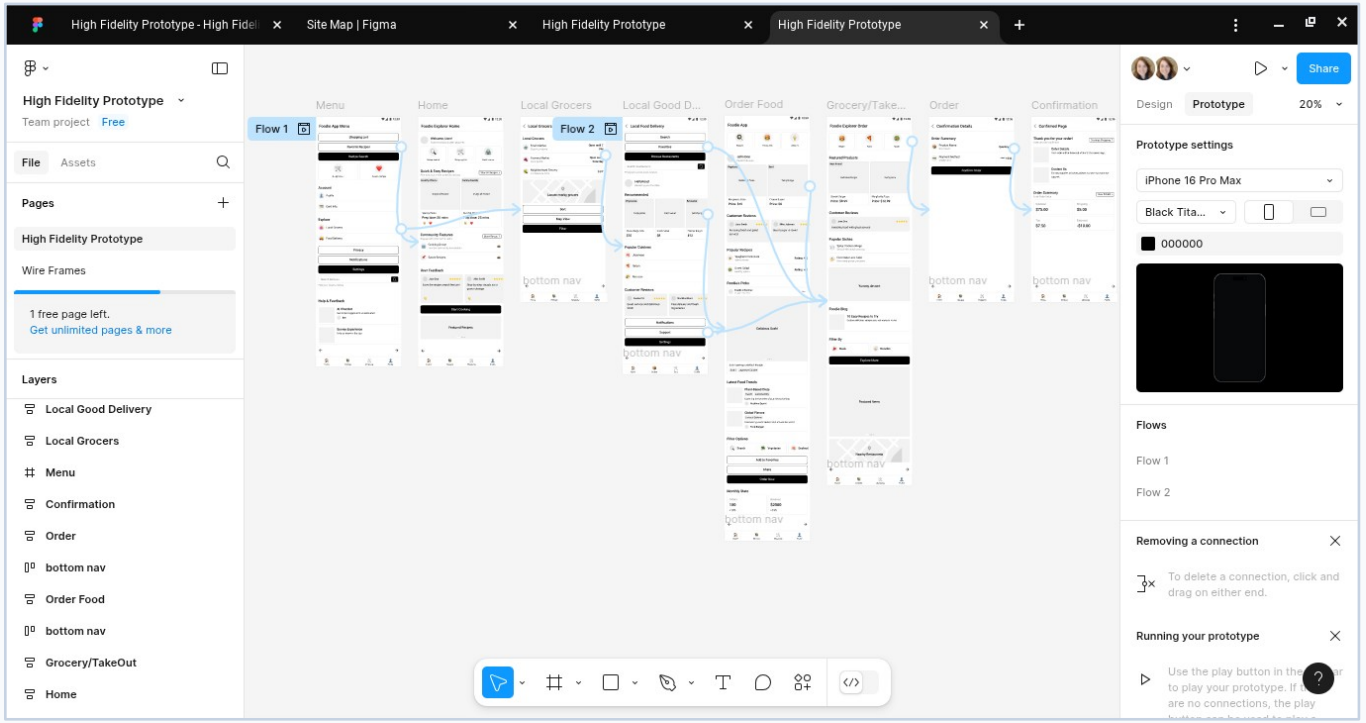


Contact Us



Message sent

High-fidelity prototype



Accessibility considerations

1

High-Contrast Mode & Readable Fonts

High-contrast mode and legible fonts keep text clear and accessible for users with visual impairments.

2

Voice Search & Screen Reader Compatibility

Voice search and screen reader support let users with motor or visual impairments navigate and interact with ease.

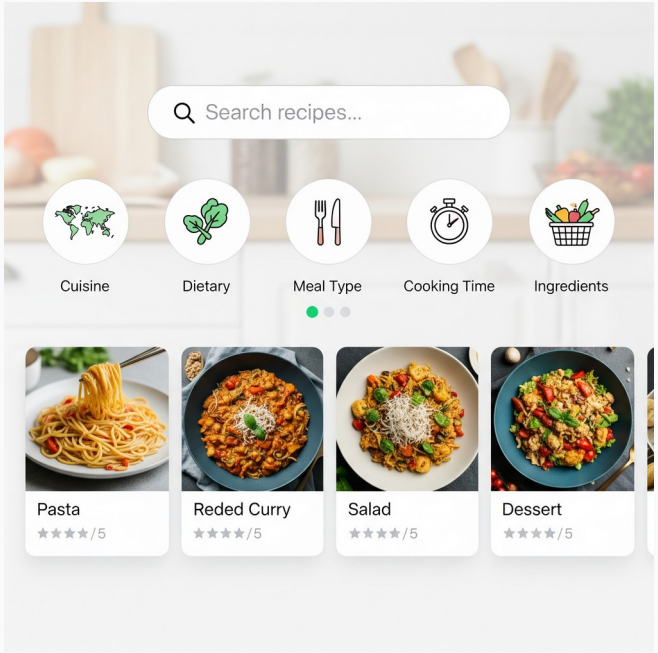
3

Clear Navigation & Large Tap Targets

Intuitive navigation with large, well-spaced buttons helps users with limited dexterity and reduces misclicks.

Key Design Decisions

- Focus on a simple path from recipe to order.
- Built an intuitive, filtered recipe search.
- Streamlined the checkout process to save user time.
- Added auto-generated shopping lists.



04

Going forward

- Takeaways
- Next steps

Takeaways

Impact:

The redesigned app streamlined grocery shopping and recipe discovery, making it easier to plan and prepare meals. One study participant noted, "The app is so intuitive and saves me so much time, now I can quickly find recipes and order groceries without stress!"

What I learned:

This project showed the value of user-centered design and iterating on real feedback. It also showed how small usability and accessibility changes can greatly improve the user experience.

Next steps

1

Conduct Further Usability Testing

More user feedback will refine features and keep the experience seamless and intuitive.

2

Enhance Personalization

Recommendations based on past orders and dietary preferences will keep users engaged.

3

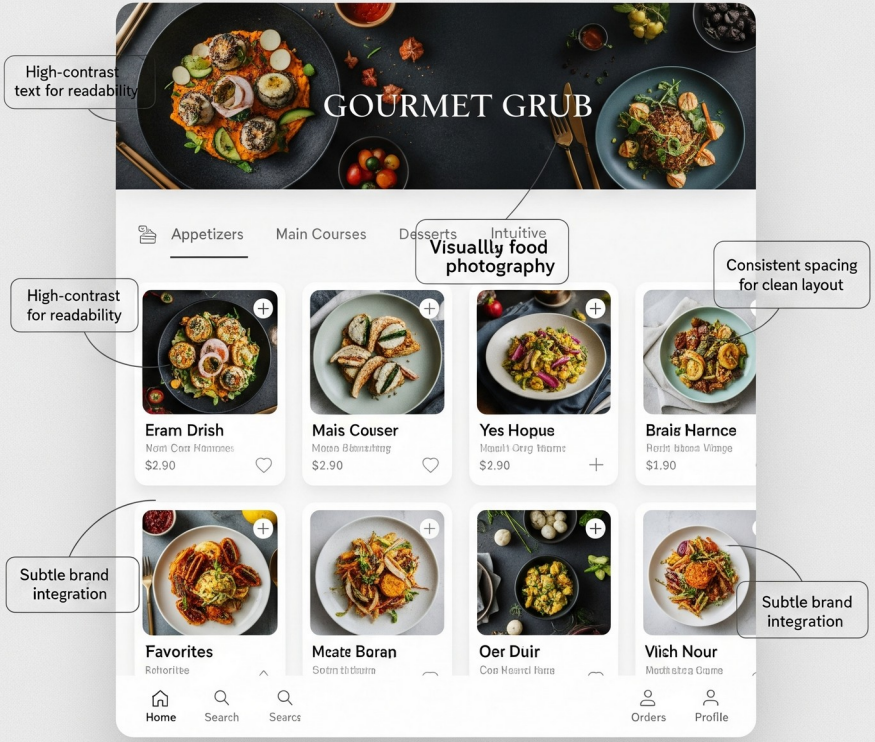
Expand Accessibility Features

Multilingual support and more assistive technologies will make the app more inclusive.

Measuring Success: KPIs

- Measure user engagement with personalized suggestions.
- Track the time saved during the streamlined checkout process.
- Monitor the completion rate for grocery list orders.
- Evaluate overall user satisfaction and efficiency.





Future Design Hypotheses

- Expand personalized recommendations based on past orders and dietary preferences.
- More usability tests will refine key features.
- Add new assistive technologies for better inclusion.
- Develop multilingual support for a global audience.

Let’s connect!

Next I would test the redesigned flows with another round of users, then build out personalization and accessibility from what I learn. The goal stays the same: a calmer, faster path from finding a recipe to getting groceries.

Reach out to discuss this project or see more of my work.

https://www.linkedin.com/in/millrjess for more case studies.

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